

Twenty - Sixth Sunday in Ordinary Time (Year A)

Errigal Parish News - 27th September 2026

Weekday Masses: St. Mary's Church: - Monday, Tuesday, and First Friday at 10am.

St. Joseph's Church: - Wednesday at 10am.

St. Mary's Church - (Vigil): Anniversary Mass -

Anniversary Mass: For Liam Mullan on Saturday 26th September at 6pm.

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St. Joseph's Church - (Vigil) - Anniversary Mass:

Month's Mind Mass - For Anna McNicholl on Sunday 27th September at 11.30am.

Month's Mind Mass: For Susie Quinn on Saturday 10th October at 6pm.

Saturday Vigil Mass 6pm - St. Joseph's Church in October.

Eucharistic Adoration: - Adoration on Monday after morning Mass.

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Living Water
Season of Creation 2026

IMMERSION IN LIVING WATER
Ezekiel 47:9, 12

Errigal Parish Mission - Revised Dates.

Due to unforeseen circumstances, our Parish Mission has had to be postponed. It will now take place from

Tuesday 27th October until Monday 2nd November.

We hope you will be able to join us for what promises to be a special week of prayer, reflection and renewal for our parish community.



Sick Visitation: Fr. Crowley will attend the sick in his care on Thursday in the morning in Glenullin and the afternoon in Ballerin/Garvagh.

Confirmation Date: St. Joseph's Church on Wednesday 28th April at 3pm.
First Communion dates will follow after consultation with each school.

St. Mary's - October Altar Society: Kathleen Connolly, Julie Mullan, Anne O'Neill, and Amanda Ferris.

St. Mary's - October Collectors - (Sunday) Brian Mullan & John McLaughlin.

St. Joseph's - October Altar Society: Claire & Tim Kilmartin.

St. Joseph's - October Counters: Patsy & May Bradley.

St. Joseph's October Collectors: (Vigil) Michael McKeown (Temple Road), John McIlvar, and Shane O'Kane (Maghermore).

(Sunday) Kevin Rafferty, Martin McIlvar, and Johnny McCloskey.

Season of Creation: The Season of Creation takes place from 1st September to 4th October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home.

We all love a good story especially with a happy ending, but today's story or parable doesn't seem to have such a happy ending, or does it?

In all or most of the stories about Jesus, we hear about trees, vineyards a corn field and more. This was the world in which Jesus lived, moved and taught. So, it's not surprising that his stories or parables were on themes his listeners would recognize and, in this case, in this case the vineyard.

But this story is also for us. What can we make of it? What or where is the vineyard today? Maybe it's a bigger place, or what Pope Francis called 'our common home', or the home we share with all creation or nature.

Having experienced a summer of contrasts, rain and extreme heat, we realize increasingly that our well-being as the human family, is interwoven with the well-being of all of God's creation.

Right now, we are in the Season of Creation, that time set aside to celebrate God's gift of creation and our responsibility to care for it. Maybe this is our vineyard!

We are being, as it were, sent into it - to do what?

First, to get to know it, to love it, to give thanks for it, which then leads us to care for it.

Each Season of Creation has a theme, and the theme this year is 'Living Water. As we think of a vineyard, we can presume it needed water, the right amount at the right time. Our Common Home, all of nature including the human family needs living water, the right amount at the right time.

Our symbol for 2026 - **Immersion in Living Water** - is a symbol of renewal and birth: water flowing from the Temple as a sign of God's caring and healing for us. We are called to step into the water, until we are so deep that we must depend on God's grace to sustain us. Those who receive this water are invited to become sources of life for others, allowing God's love to flow through them into the world. And thus, the water of God will become in us "a spring of water welling up to eternal life", as Jesus promised (John 4:14).

Parish Pastoral Group: The next meeting of the Parish Pastoral Group (to prepare for the Mission) will take place in the Parochial House on Tuesday 29th September at 7.30pm.

Parish Safeguarding: Vetting process will take place on the first Saturday of every month after the Vigil Mass. This will be to re-vet all existing volunteers as a new requirement from the Diocese. If you are over 18 and volunteer as a Sacristan /Choir leader /Children's Liturgy helper or Baptism Group helper for the parish please attend a meeting, on Saturday 3rd October in Glenullin P.S. Top site 6:45pm -7:45pm or Saturday 7th November in Ballerin Parochial house 6:45pm-7:45pm, at your convenience. Please bring 3 forms of ID with you to the meeting for verification purposes. These will be scanned for parish records.

NB: Most of the Youth ministry volunteers have been recently vetted and therefore do not need to attend.

Mass Cards (pre-signed): Signed Mass cards for all occasions are available in the side porch of St. Mary's Church as requested by parishioners. A suggested donation of £5 is requested with the name of the recipient in a brown envelope included. Please put the brown envelope in the St.Vincent dePaul box, where it will be retrieved and the monies and Mass intention will be offered locally or by another priest.

Sacrament of Reconciliation: Sacrament of Reconciliation (Confession) available after the Vigil Mass on request.

Ulster Retreat Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland invite you to their Ulster Retreat Day on Saturday 3rd October, from 10am - 6pm at Benburb Priory. A day of prayer, reflection, and spiritual renewal with guest speakers Fr Barry Matthews, Fr Gerry Campbell, Helen Stewart and Jim Deeds. Lunch and refreshments provided. Cost: £45. Booking: www.catholicmothers.ie/retreats All welcome - bring a friend.

Eucharistic Adoration: Derry Diocese is renewing and developing its Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee in order to increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout the diocese. You are welcome to attend an Information Meeting on Wednesday 30th September at 8pm, in The Drummond Hotel, Ballykelly. Registration and light refreshments from 7.30pm.

Errigal SVP: Could You Spare a Little Time to Help Others? As we prepare to celebrate the Feast of St Vincent de Paul (27th September), the Errigal St Vincent de Paul (SVP) Conference need a couple of volunteers to join our local team. This is a wonderful opportunity to put your faith into action, give something back to our community, and make a real difference to the lives of local individuals and families who are struggling.

No previous experience is necessary. You will be warmly welcomed and fully supported by our local SVP Volunteers, with guidance and training provided.

If you would like to find out more, please contact us on 07563595868. We'd be delighted to hear from you. For more details, please see <https://www.svp.ie/northern-ireland/>

Annual Safeguarding Mass: Bishop Router invites everyone involved in Safeguarding to the Annual Safeguarding Mass on Friday 2nd October at 7.30pm in St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry. The Safeguarding Mass will be offered for peace, reconciliation and healing for all who have suffered the pain of abuse. The Mass will also be offered in thanksgiving for the Parish Safeguarding Representatives in the parishes across the diocese, and diocesan staff and volunteers who continue to work and support ongoing safeguarding practices across our diocese. Everyone is welcome to attend this Mass.

Queen's University Catholic Chaplaincy: Reopens for the new academic year on Monday 14th September, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming. The first Sunday Mass will be celebrated on 20th September at the new, earlier time of 7.00pm. Please note the new time! New or returning student? Find out about what's on, ways to connect and get involved, and student accommodation at Ryan Hall at qubcatholic.org and on our socials. Staff and alumni are always welcome too. Visit our newly renewed Chaplaincy at [28 Elmwood Avenue](#) for Mass, Confessions or candle-lighting - and call into Mosaic for some of the best coffee, hot lunches and home-baked treats in South Belfast!

Could You Help Share the True Spirit of Christmas? Each year, volunteers in parishes across the north of Ireland set up a small stall after Masses to sell **Trócaire's Gifts of Change** - meaningful gifts that make a real difference to families living in poverty around the world. We provide everything you need including training and support. All we ask is a little time and a big heart. Last Christmas, 50 parishes took part - and we'd love to grow that number even more this year! If you would like to find out more about how you can help, please email Mark at mark.mcmahon@trocaire.org or call 028 9080 8030.

Errigal: Through Our Eyes - Summer Youth Photography Project: Starting Monday 6th July, all young people under 18 are invited to join Errigal: Through Our Eyes, a summer photography project. The theme is "See what matters. See where God is." This will celebrate the beauty, faith, kindness, and everyday life of our parish.

Pick up an entry form, then send up to three photos taken within the parish boundaries and a short reflection to the parish email (with parent/guardian consent for under-16s). There are 1st, 2nd and 3rd place prizes in both Primary and Secondary categories, with certificates for everyone. **Update Deadline - Please note that the closing date for entries has been postponed until the end of September. We warmly encourage all our young people to take part and share their photographs and reflections. More details will follow soon.**

Michael English Church Concert: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2nd October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Gift Aid/Census Cards: Can we please request the return of Gift Aid and Census cards recently circulated so that parish records can be updated during the summer months.

Rosary and Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament: Will continue the first Monday of each month. St. Joseph's Church - 7.30pm.

Monday Adoration Adorers: We request if you are available on Monday from after the morning Mass to participate in the rota for Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament which takes place until 2.30pm. If interested, please leave your name/contact number in the sacristy and we will follow up.

Parish Collections - Thank you. 183 boxes of envelopes in circulation.

Returns (Pink/Yellow - 83 White - 66)

St. Mary's - Parish: £590 Renovation: £250

St. Joseph's - Parish: £230 Renovation: £245

Ballerin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 3, 6, 9, 16. Jackpot is £3520. Lucky Dip Winner £50 - Feargal & Ciara Deighan.

Glenullin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 6, 7, 19, and 30. Jackpot £10,000. £25 winners - Jodie Sheehan, Michael McKeown, Fiona Fisher, and Majella McCloskey.

Readers & Eucharistic Ministers

St. Mary's Church - Church Readers - 3rd/4th October

Saturday Vigil -

Sunday Morning - Aileen Mullan.

If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Mary's Church, please give your name to Fr. Crowley training will be provided.

Eucharistic Ministers - 3rd/4th October

Saturday Vigil -

Sunday Morning - Martina Bradley & Gillian O'Neill.

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Readers & Eucharistic Ministers

St. Joseph's Church - Church Readers - 3rd/4th October

Saturday Vigil - Roisin McGinley.

Sunday Morning - Ciara Mullan.

If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Joseph's Church, please give your name to Fr. Crowley or Mairead McNicholl (Lector Co-Ordinator), training will be provided.

Eucharistic Ministers - 3rd/4th October

Saturday Vigil - Grainne O'Kane Declan McNicholl.

Sunday Morning - Clare Mullan & Meabh Close.

Feasts during the Week: Monday - Ss. Lawrence Ruiz and Companions: During the period 1633 - 37 these sixteen martyrs shed their blood out of love for Christ in the city of Nagasaki, Japan. **Tuesday - Archangels - Gabriel, Raphael, and Michael:** Gabriel brought the message to Mary at the Annunciation. Michael has been venerated as protector of Christians in general and soldiers in particular. Raphael was guide to Tobias. **Wednesday - St. Jerome (310 - 420):** Translated the Bible into Latin, known as the Vulgate, and wrote commentaries on scripture. Patron of librarians. **Thursday - St. Therese of Lisieux:** Marie Francois Therese Martin died at the Carmel in Lisieux on 30th September 1897. She was declared a Doctor of the Church by Pope John Paul II in 1997. She is Patron of the missions and of France. **Friday - Guardian Angels:** We venerate the Guardian Angels seeking their constant protection. **Angel of God my guardian dear to whom God's love commits us here. Ever this day be at my side, to light and guard, to rule and guide. Amen. Saturday - Bl. Columba Marmion:** Was born in Dublin in 1858. He was ordained in Rome in 1881. He was elected abbot in the Abbey of Maredsous, Belgium in 1886. Among his influential writings - are his trilogy, 'Christ the Life of the Soul', 'Christ in His Mysteries', and the 'ideal of the Monk'. His spiritual writings influenced many in religious life during the twentieth century.

Diocesan Vocations: In the words of St Paul in our second reading, we pray that the men called to serve as priests of our diocese will '...be united in their convictions and in their love.....with no competition among them, no conceit; but everybody self-effacing, always considering the other person to be better than themselves, each one thinking of other people's interests first.' "In your minds you must be the same as Christ Jesus."

Are you 18 years or older and thinking or wondering about serving the Church as a priest of the diocese of Derry? There will be an afternoon Talk with time for Prayer, Discussion, Questions & Answers in Derry on Sunday 11th October.

For further information, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Anniversaries: It is advisable where possible to book well in advance in the case of anniversaries. These are arranged with a sacristan as the anniversary book is kept in the sacristy. Also, please indicate in the Anniversary book that the Mass is booked for the stated intention - we would appreciate an acknowledgment of the booking by email if possible. **In the case of a booked Anniversary Mass please inquire of the sacristan before the Mass begins that the Mass is offered for the intention you request.** Names to be added to the weekend anniversary list need to be added to the anniversary book by informing the sacristan - this can be done in advance of the date requested.

Parish Readers/Eucharistic Ministers: If you are unable to attend the schedule allocated to you, it would be much appreciated if you can get a replacement to step in for you. (It may be possible to exchange a rotation with another group member - there is also the opportunity to seek cover via the Whatsapp messaging facility if available to your group). I also ask Readers please to conclude the readings with - '**The Word of the Lord**' as directed in the Missalette, and not 'This is the Word of the Lord' as stated in the Lectionary. We have previously discussed this at our reader meetings.

Look out Leaflets...Are now available for children at the back of both churches in the parish focusing on the liturgy of the word each week. Enjoy!

Teach us to Pray Booklet - It can be downloaded at:
<https://www.derrydiocese.org/news/teach-us-to-pray>.

Why Sunday Matters! The Irish Catholic Bishops' Conference have published a pastoral message titled '*Why Sunday Matters*' - an invitation to reflect on Sunday Mass. To access this resource and watch a four-part video series titles Sunday Mass - 'Digging Deeper', visit at CatholicBishops.ie

TheWay.ie: Is a new digital platform set up by the Irish Bishops Conference dedicated to sharing the 'Good News' and the witness of the Catholic Church in Ireland. It is intended to help people discover the faith, live the faith and pass on the faith. It is for both seekers and followers. Follow us on Facebook, Instagram, X and YouTube.

St. Joseph's Church - A YouTube camera link is now available for services from St. Joseph's Church, Glenullin. The link can be accessed -
<https://youtube.com@parishoferrigalderry>.

The Net: As always, it features a wide variety of news, interesting and inspiring interviews, articles, and photos from parishes across the diocese. You can read the Diocesan newspaper on-line at: www.derrydiocese.org/news/categories/the-net. or a paper copy is available at the back of the church. Donations welcome.

Prayer for Peace in the Middle East: God of mercy and compassion of grace and reconciliation, pour your presence upon all your children in the Middle East: Jews, Muslims,

Christians, Palestinians, and Israelis. Let hatred be turned into love, fear to trust, despair to hope, oppression to freedom, occupation to liberation. That violent encounters may be replaced by loving embraces, and peace and justice maybe experienced by all. Amen.

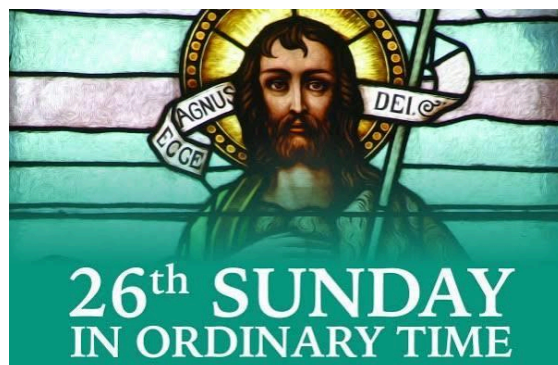
St. Joseph's Church: We present a dual gauge to initiative funds in our parish for the on-going costs associated with the renovation of St. Joseph's Church. The gauge on the left indicates the funds we require to complete the refurbishment. The gauge on the right reflects the loans we have received from other parishes. (Gauge also available on website and Facebook page). **Thanks - Donations to date** - Current figure £235,400.00.

Providing compassionate care at the end of life - To address the sensitive issue of compassionate care at the end of life, and in response to the need to inform the faithful of Catholic teaching on this important life issue that affects so many families, the Bishops of Ireland have published the pastoral letter: Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes. You are invited to read this letter and view the accompanying video Through the Valley, which offers personal testimonies by carers and people with terminal illness. The key message of both letter and video asserts that every person possesses inherent, infinite dignity that remains intact regardless of their circumstances. In this context, bishops strongly oppose the Oireachtas Committee's proposal to Government to legislate for assisted suicide and call on support for healthcare workers who uphold the sanctity of life. To read Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes and to watch Through the Valley, visit the following link: <https://www.catholicbishops.ie/2024/06/24/bishops-statement-on-end-of-life-care-freedom-to-live-fully-until-death-comes/>

The Catholic Communications Office of the Irish Bishops Conference: Produces a five-story weekly ezine Sharing Good News that reports on stories associated with the Bishops' Conference, activities in parishes and dioceses, and that celebrates Church life generally. If you do not currently subscribe to receiving it and you wish to subscribe to receive Sharing Good News, please register your email address on <https://catholicnews.ie/newsletter/>

Errigal Hall Volunteers: For this hospitality to continue in the community, we need new volunteers to come forward and help in this voluntary service to the parish. If you are interested, please contact Melinda Robinson. If enough volunteers come forward a rota can be put in place via a WhatsApp group, so that the same people are not required at each function.

Errigal Hall: Parishioners who borrow items from the hall need to sign for their removal from the hall and when they are returned. The signing book is in the kitchen of the hall.



St. Joseph's Church: Choir Practice will take place each Tuesday at 7pm in the church. New members from Primary 4 up are very welcome. Any queries contact Roisin McIlvar [07841407154](tel:07841407154).

St. Mary's Church Choir: If you are interested in joining the choir, you are welcome to attend the practice in the church on a Wednesday evening at 7pm. Or contact any choir member.

Derry Diocesan Society (DDS): In each of the parishes of the diocese Mass is offered alternating in each parish (list at the back of each church) for deceased and living members who are registered in the society. The deceased members registered are remembered in the anniversary list for three consecutive weekends each quarter (three months). Registration is £20 and can be given to a sacristan or Fr. Crowley - please ensure name and address of the person to be enrolled is included and whether it is for a living or deceased member.

Maternity Blessing: Expectant mothers are welcome to receive a blessing in any of the sacristies following Mass - and a prayer card for their pregnancy.

Stamps: For the missions can be left at the back of each church.

Synodal Pathway: Find attached the final versions of the National Synthesis for the Church in Ireland, which is the fruit of the recent process of listening and consultation; it is based on the syntheses produced by the 26 dioceses in Ireland, as well as those submitted by religious congregations and other interested groups. Also attach appendix document from survivors of abuse and the Irish Bishops' Conference Cover Letter, which have all been forwarded to the General Secretariat of the Synod of Bishops. Press Release also attached. We are requested to bring the Report to the attention of your parishioners and to share it on your social media outlets. It will be a useful tool as parishes move forward on the synodal journey in the autumn. **The Report is now available on the website of the Synodal Pathway of the Church in Ireland website: www.synod.ie**



Parish Envelopes: Following previous discussion with the Parish Finance Committee we encourage consideration for those who use envelopes infrequently to consider the use of a standing order, (through this medium you have full control), of the donation at your disposal. **Further information is available from the parish website.**

If you advance the standing order, (it can be processed on-line with your bank), or alternatively bring the completed mandate to your bank. We request that when you are issuing your instruction to the bank, that you do so with your personal name, in doing so we can therefore identify from whom the standing order has been authorised. It is with your authorisation that

the standing order is either processed weekly or monthly. Also, you can withdraw the mandate at your own discretion. We would appreciate an acknowledgement of this transaction (via the parish email) when it is activated, so that we can have a copy for the parish records. In the information forwarded we will require your address and telephone number.

Several parishioners recently have set up a standing order, however we do not know who these parishioners are because they have not provided an address. We ask please that you follow the instructions above and email the parish to inform us who has authorised the standing order.

We request now that the boxes are delivered, if you have not previously returned or updated a parish Census card, please complete the card in the back of the box and return in the collection envelope. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be signed and returned if you are a taxpayer.

Those who avail of Standing Orders are also asked to complete a Census card and Gift Aid card. These can be collected in each sacristy and returned at your convenience.

Details of Parish Accounts for Standing Orders:

(Errigal Ballerin: Sort Code - 950346 - Account No. 40067059 is the No 1 a/c) **Errigal Development:** Sort Code - 950346 - (Account No. 90042358 is the Renovation a/c).

(Errigal Glenullin: Sort Code - 950346 Account No. 90062596 is the No 1 a/c) **(Errigal Parish:** Sort Code 950689 - Account No. 90083712 is the Renovation a/c).

Parish Finance: If you wish to contribute to the parish by standing order - forms can be forwarded upon request by sending an email to - errigalparish@gmail.com or they are available on the parish website. At the end of each month, we shall include in the collection figures the amounts relating to the increase in standing orders, these figures are stated in brackets.

Parish Census: In the recent distribution of collection envelopes, we request that at your earliest convenience you might return the census card with your family details for parish registration. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be updated and signed so that the parish can claim Gift Aid if you are a taxpayer, this does not affect your personal details or taxation. If your tax circumstances change, please inform us, if you are no longer a taxpayer.

Census cards are available in each sacristy, once completed they can be returned in a sealed envelope via the collection box at the back of each church. If you have previously registered, you do not have to do so again, unless your household occupation has changed.

Church Cleaners: Cleaners are required to join the existing monthly groups who clean each church. The more that participate the less occasions that individuals will be required to cover. If interested, please leave your name/contact phone number in each sacristy or alternatively give details to a sacristan.

Mass Cards/Mass Bouquets: Are available for sale at the back of each church please put the money in the candle box.

ACCORD - Counselling: If you need to speak, to an experienced couples and relationships counsellor during this time of unprecedented stress and pressure on family life, please contact 95680151. This is a free helpline service available from 9am - 8pm. Monday to Friday. All calls charged at local rate.

ACCORD DERRY: Virtual Interactive Marriage Preparation Programme (limited to 15 couples per course). Booking now online at www.accordni.com

Radio Maria Ireland: <https://www.radiomaria.ie/radio-maria-ireland/> is an Irish-run Catholic Talk-Radio Station with commercial-free broadcasting of Prayer, Catechesis, Music, Talks, Interviews and Testimonies.

Church Safeguarding: If you have any concerns with regard to Safeguarding children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact: Mrs Marie O’Kane (Designated Liaison Person), Diocesan Pastoral Centre, 164 Bishop Street, Derry. Tel: 02871 - 362475/07596500793. Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org - or PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 or Social Services Tel: 02871-314090.

Parish Representatives - Tracey McGilligan and Clare Mullan.

Errigal Privacy Notice: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website or alternatively it is available from the Parish Office. Live stream of Mass and Services in St. Mary’s Church and a Utube streaming in St. Joseph’s Church are available online. Parishioners should note that the first three rows of seats are visible in St. Mary’s Church.